

AcmeCloud Support & Operations Handbook

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Introduction & Customer Support Overview

1. About AcmeCloud

AcmeCloud is a cloud-based productivity and collaboration platform designed for individuals, small teams, and growing organizations. Customers can use AcmeCloud to manage projects, collaborate with team members, store files, generate reports, and integrate their existing systems through the AcmeCloud API.

AcmeCloud provides four subscription plans:

- Free
- Starter
- Professional
- Business

Each plan provides different limits for storage, team members, API access, analytics, and customer support.

The purpose of this handbook is to help AcmeCloud support engineers resolve common customer questions consistently.

2. Support Principles

Support engineers should:

1. Verify the customer's identity before discussing account-specific information.
2. Never expose passwords, authentication tokens, API keys, or payment card information.
3. Use customer-specific tools or internal systems when answering questions about individual accounts.
4. Use official AcmeCloud documentation when answering questions about product behavior or company policies.
5. Avoid making assumptions when account information is unavailable.
6. Escalate issues that require engineering, security, or financial intervention.

Customer-specific information includes:

- Subscription status
- Invoice information
- Order history
- Payment history
- Support tickets
- Account email address

- Usage information

General product information does not require customer verification.

For example:

"What is AcmeCloud's refund policy?"

is a general documentation question.

However:

"Can I get a refund for my last invoice?"

requires access to the customer's billing information.

3. Support Priority Levels

Support tickets are categorized into four priority levels.

Low

General questions, documentation requests, cosmetic issues, and feature suggestions.

Medium

Issues affecting individual users where a workaround exists.

High

Issues affecting important functionality where no reasonable workaround is available.

Urgent

Security incidents, widespread outages, significant billing errors, or problems affecting multiple customers.

Urgent issues should be escalated immediately.

Subscription Plans

4. AcmeCloud Plans

AcmeCloud offers four subscription plans.

Free

The Free plan is intended for individuals evaluating AcmeCloud.

Included:

- Up to 1 team member
- 5 GB storage
- Basic project management
- Standard email support
- Limited reporting
- No API access

The Free plan does not include priority support.

Starter

The Starter plan is intended for small teams.

Included:

- Up to 5 team members
- 50 GB storage
- Basic reporting
- Standard integrations
- API access
- Standard support

Starter customers may purchase additional storage and team-member add-ons.

Professional

The Professional plan is intended for professional teams requiring advanced functionality.

Included:

- Up to 20 team members
- 500 GB storage
- Advanced analytics
- API access
- Advanced reporting
- Priority support

Professional customers receive faster support response times than Free and Starter customers.

Business

The Business plan is intended for larger organizations.

Included:

- Up to 100 team members
- 5 TB storage
- Advanced analytics
- API access
- Priority support
- Organization-level administration
- Advanced security controls

Business customers can contact their account representative for enterprise requirements that are not available through the standard Business plan.

5. Changing Plans

Customers can upgrade their subscription at any time.

When upgrading:

- The new plan becomes available immediately.
- Additional functionality is activated shortly after payment confirmation.
- The customer may receive a prorated charge depending on the billing cycle.

Customers can downgrade at the end of their current billing period.

Downgrading does not immediately remove access to the existing plan's features.

However, if the customer's storage usage exceeds the new plan's storage limit, new uploads may be disabled until the customer reduces storage usage or upgrades again.

Billing & Invoices

6. Billing Cycles

AcmeCloud subscriptions are normally billed annually.

The billing date is determined by the subscription start date.

For example, if a customer starts a subscription on March 12, their next annual renewal will normally occur on March 12 of the following year.

Customers can view their billing information from the Billing section of the AcmeCloud dashboard.

7. Invoices

An invoice is generated whenever a paid subscription is created or renewed.

Invoices contain:

- Invoice number
- Customer information
- Subscription plan
- Amount
- Issue date
- Due date
- Payment status

Possible invoice statuses include:

- Paid
- Pending
- Overdue

A **Paid** invoice indicates that payment was successfully processed.

A **Pending** invoice indicates that payment has not yet been confirmed.

An **Overdue** invoice indicates that the payment deadline has passed without successful payment.

8. Failed Payments

If a subscription renewal payment fails, AcmeCloud may temporarily restrict access to certain paid functionality.

Customers should first verify:

1. Their payment method is valid.
2. Their payment method has not expired.
3. Their bank has not declined the transaction.
4. Their billing information is correct.

After updating the payment method, the customer can retry the payment from the Billing page.

Support engineers must not request complete credit card numbers from customers.

9. Duplicate Charges

If a customer believes they were charged twice, support should first verify the customer's invoices and payment records.

Possible explanations include:

- One charge is an authorization hold.
- A subscription renewal and an additional purchase occurred close together.
- A payment was retried after an initial failure.
- A genuine duplicate transaction occurred.

If two successful transactions correspond to the same invoice or purchase, the issue should be escalated to the billing team.

Customers should not be promised an immediate refund until the transaction has been verified.

Refund Policy

10. Standard Refund Policy

AcmeCloud offers a **14-day refund period** for eligible purchases.

Customers may request a refund within 14 days of the original purchase.

Annual subscription purchases are generally eligible for a full refund when the request is submitted within this period.

Refund eligibility depends on the transaction type and the circumstances surrounding the request.

11. Billing Errors

Billing errors may qualify for a refund even when the normal 14-day period has expired.

Examples include:

- Verified duplicate charges
- Incorrect subscription charges
- Charges caused by a confirmed billing system error

A support engineer should verify the transaction before promising a refund.

If the issue cannot be verified using available customer data, the request should be escalated to the billing team.

12. Third-Party Purchases

Purchases made through third-party marketplaces may be subject to the marketplace's refund policies.

AcmeCloud support may provide general guidance but cannot directly refund transactions processed entirely by a third-party marketplace.

Customers should contact the marketplace where the purchase was originally completed.

13. Refund Processing

Approved refunds are returned to the original payment method whenever possible.

Refund processing time depends on the customer's payment provider.

AcmeCloud support should not guarantee an exact bank processing time.

If a refund has been approved but has not appeared after the expected processing period, support should verify the refund transaction and escalate to billing if necessary.

14. Refund Decision Examples

Example A

Customer purchased an annual Professional subscription five days ago and wants to cancel.

Result: Generally eligible for a refund.

Example B

Customer purchased an annual subscription six months ago and simply changed their mind.

Result: Normally not eligible under the standard refund policy.

Example C

Customer was charged twice for the same subscription renewal.

Result: Investigate as a potential billing error.

Example D

Customer purchased AcmeCloud through a third-party marketplace.

Result: Customer should normally request the refund through the marketplace.

Feature Access & Permissions

15. Why a Customer May Not See a Feature

A customer may be unable to access a feature for several reasons.

Common causes include:

- The feature is not included in the customer's subscription.
- The customer's subscription has expired.
- The customer's payment is overdue.
- The feature requires an administrator permission.
- The customer's organization has disabled the feature.
- The feature has not yet been enabled for the account.
- The customer is using an outdated application version.

Support engineers should determine which condition applies before recommending a solution.

16. Advanced Analytics

Advanced Analytics is available on the Professional and Business plans.

Starter and Free customers cannot access Advanced Analytics unless they upgrade to an eligible plan.

If a Professional or Business customer cannot access Advanced Analytics, support should verify:

1. Current subscription status.
 2. Current plan.
 3. User permissions.
 4. Whether the organization administrator has disabled the feature.
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17. API Access

API access is available on:

- Starter
- Professional

- Business

API access is not included with the Free plan.

Customers using API access must authenticate requests using API credentials.

API credentials must never be shared publicly or included in support tickets.

If an API request returns an authentication error, the customer should verify that:

- The API credential is active.
 - The credential has not expired.
 - The correct environment is being used.
 - The API endpoint is correct.
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18. Team Member Limits

Each plan has a maximum number of team members.

Free: 1 member

Starter: 5 members

Professional: 20 members

Business: 100 members

If a customer reaches their team-member limit, they may upgrade their plan or remove an existing team member.

Adding a team member does not automatically upgrade the customer's subscription.

Troubleshooting Guide

19. Customer Cannot Log In

If a customer cannot log in:

Step 1

Ask the customer to verify that they are using the correct email address.

Step 2

Ask them to use the password reset functionality.

Step 3

If the password reset email does not arrive, ask the customer to check their spam or junk folder.

Step 4

If the problem continues, check whether the account is active.

Account-specific investigation should use internal customer information rather than assumptions.

20. Dashboard Is Not Loading

If the dashboard does not load:

1. Ask the customer to refresh the browser.
2. Ask them to try a private/incognito browser window.
3. Ask them to verify their internet connection.
4. Ask them to try a supported browser.
5. Check whether AcmeCloud is experiencing a known service incident.

If multiple customers report the same problem, escalate the issue as a potential service outage.

21. File Upload Failure

File uploads can fail because of:

- File size restrictions
- Storage limits
- Unsupported file formats
- Temporary network problems
- Account restrictions

Support should first check whether the customer's account has enough available storage.

If storage is available and the issue affects multiple file types, the issue may require technical investigation.

22. API Errors

Common API errors include:

401 Unauthorized

Usually indicates missing, invalid, or expired credentials.

403 Forbidden

Usually indicates that the authenticated account does not have permission to perform the requested operation.

404 Not Found

Usually indicates that the requested resource or endpoint does not exist.

429 Too Many Requests

Indicates that the customer has exceeded the applicable API rate limit.

500 Internal Server Error

Indicates a server-side error. Customers experiencing repeated 500 errors should provide the request timestamp and relevant request ID when contacting support.

Account Security

23. Security Rules

Support engineers must never request or store:

- Customer passwords
- Full payment card numbers
- Authentication tokens
- API secrets

- Recovery codes
- Private encryption keys

If a customer accidentally sends sensitive credentials in a support ticket, the information should be treated as compromised and the appropriate security process should be followed.

24. Account Verification

Before discussing sensitive account information, support should verify the customer's identity according to the applicable support procedure.

General documentation can be provided without account verification.

For example:

"How does the refund policy work?"

does not require access to the customer's account.

However:

"Was my refund approved?"

requires account-specific investigation.

25. Suspicious Account Activity

Potential account compromise indicators include:

- Unexpected password reset requests
- Unknown login activity
- Unexpected subscription changes
- Unrecognized purchases
- Unexpected API activity

Potential security incidents should be escalated to the security team.

Support engineers should not attempt to investigate security incidents beyond their authorized procedures.

Support Ticket Procedures

26. Creating a Support Ticket

A support ticket should contain:

- Customer ID
- Issue category
- Short description
- Detailed description
- Priority
- Relevant timestamps
- Request IDs where applicable

Categories include:

- Billing
 - Technical
 - Account
 - Subscription
 - Feature Request
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27. Ticket Statuses

Tickets can have the following statuses:

Open

The ticket has been created but has not yet been actively investigated.

In Progress

A support engineer is currently investigating the issue.

Resolved

A solution has been provided or the issue has otherwise been resolved.

Closed

The ticket has been completed and requires no further action.

A resolved ticket may be reopened if the customer reports that the original issue persists.

28. Escalation Guidelines

Escalate to Engineering when:

- The issue appears to be caused by a software defect.
- Multiple customers report the same technical problem.
- An API endpoint consistently returns unexpected server errors.
- Data appears to be missing or corrupted.

Escalate to Billing when:

- A duplicate successful charge is confirmed.
- A refund requires manual processing.
- An invoice amount appears incorrect.
- A payment transaction cannot be reconciled.

Escalate to Security when:

- Account compromise is suspected.
 - Credentials may have been exposed.
 - Unauthorized access is suspected.
 - Suspicious API activity is detected.
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Frequently Asked Questions

29. Can I cancel my subscription?

Yes. Customers can cancel their subscription through the account billing settings.

Cancellation normally prevents the next renewal. It does not necessarily result in an automatic refund for the current billing period.

Refund eligibility is determined separately according to the refund policy.

30. Can I upgrade immediately?

Yes. Customers can upgrade to an eligible higher-tier plan at any time.

The upgraded features become available after the upgrade is successfully processed.

31. Can I downgrade immediately?

Downgrades normally take effect at the end of the current billing period.

Customers should review their storage and team-member usage before downgrading.

32. Why can't I use Advanced Analytics?

Advanced Analytics is available on Professional and Business plans.

If the customer already has an eligible subscription, support should check account permissions and organization-level settings.

33. How do I get an invoice?

Invoices are available through the Billing section of the customer's AcmeCloud account.

Support can also retrieve invoice information using authorized internal customer systems.

34. I was charged twice. What should I do?

The customer should contact support with the approximate transaction date and amount.

Support should inspect the customer's invoice and payment records to determine whether the charges represent:

- A duplicate transaction
- An authorization hold
- Separate purchases

- A renewal plus an additional purchase

Confirmed duplicate charges should be escalated to Billing.

35. Can I get a refund?

Customers should provide information about the purchase so support can determine eligibility.

Purchases within the 14-day refund period are generally eligible, subject to the applicable refund rules.

Verified billing errors may qualify for a refund even outside the standard refund period.

Internal Support Decision Guide

36. General Decision Process

When receiving a customer question, determine whether the question is:

General Knowledge

Examples:

- "What plans do you offer?"
- "What is your refund policy?"
- "Does the Starter plan have API access?"
- "How many users can the Professional plan support?"

These questions can normally be answered using official documentation.

Customer-Specific

Examples:

- "What's my current subscription?"
- "When is my next renewal?"
- "Show me my last three invoices."

- "Do I have any open support tickets?"
- "What did I purchase last month?"

These questions require authorized access to customer data.

Mixed Questions

Some questions require both documentation and customer information.

Example:

"Can I get a refund for my latest purchase?"

The support system should:

1. Identify the customer's latest purchase.
2. Determine the purchase date.
3. Retrieve relevant transaction information.
4. Consult the refund policy.
5. Determine whether the transaction appears eligible.
6. Explain the result without promising an outcome that requires manual approval.

Another example:

"Why can't I access Advanced Analytics?"

The system should:

1. Identify the customer's current subscription.
 2. Determine whether Advanced Analytics is included.
 3. Check relevant account information.
 4. Consult the feature-access documentation.
 5. Explain the likely reason.
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37. Important Support Rule

Customer-specific data and company documentation serve different purposes.

Documentation explains **what AcmeCloud's policies and systems are supposed to do**.

Customer data explains **what is currently happening with a specific customer**.

Neither source should automatically replace the other.

For account-specific questions, support engineers should use verified customer data.

For policy and product questions, support engineers should use the latest official documentation.

For questions involving both policy and account information, both sources may be required.